



platform for (say) wealth advisory (services), home loans... I think the physical and digital will coexist in India. And we are trying to ensure that we don't miss out on that.

Q: The chairman of one of India's largest private sector banks recently told me that technology is the new arms race when it comes to banking and financial services. Do you agree with this? What is the technology focus that you have?

A: I think technology is going to be central to everybody's agenda... Banks, I think, adopted technology much earlier than many of the other industries. Core banking itself is almost 25-30 years old... At SBI, we have been one of the pioneers in terms of technology adoption, both for branch banking as well as digital banking. What is the next step? The point I mentioned about resilience; it is important that while we create the digital channels or alternate channels, the availability of the channel 24/7 is very important. This means we need to create resilience in our digital channels... this is what we are focussing on. YONO 2.0 is all about increasing the capability of this app to handle growing volumes. Today, if you take away the financial inclusion customers, the Jan Dhan accounts, zero-balance accounts, we have around 30 crore-plus (300-million-plus) customers who are non-financial inclusion customers, but we have just about 8 crore (80 million) customers on our YONO app. We want to bring as many people as possible, both from the financial inclusion side as well as non-financial inclusion side to the app.

Q: What kind of size and shape do you see YONO 2.0 taking a few years from now? What is the long-term shape that it will take eventually?

A: YONO 1.0 was revolutionary when we launched it... It's not a pure banking app. Today, we sell many of the non-banking products also... insurance, mutual funds, credit cards... And additionally, we've created a marketplace... it's a combination of marketplace, banking, and non-banking financial services... but a lot of people have caught up. What we are trying to do in YONO 2.0, is it was [earlier] essentially a mobile offering... But we also have a large platform in terms of branch channel. We have a large platform in terms of internet banking... And we have a large number of feet on street, people who source applications for us. So, [what] we are trying to do with YONO 2.0 is not only about mobile... We are re-imagining our brand journeys, how feet on street

will work, how contact centres will work and more importantly how internet banking works with a common goal. That means if you start a journey with the brands and you have some work to go to office and you want to complete the rest of the journey on the go, you can start where you left off. Today it's not possible because they are all silos.

Q: As the head of the country's largest banking institution, what is your assessment of the credit markets, and the investment appetite of India Inc.?

A: I think we have witnessed good credit growth post-Covid... also because there was pent-up demand. It is also a fact that much of that credit growth had come from the retail personal [space], whether unsecured personal loans or home loans. Home loans is a very

“To get this idea of consistency, productivity and resilience across, we have initiated the largest staff outreach programme ever attempted at SBI”

important category of growth. What we also witnessed is that two important segments are growing—MSME and agriculture. We have witnessed almost 16-17% credit growth rate in these two sectors. It is also possible that while the demand was always there, the ability of the banks to look at these customers from a different lens [wasn't]. Because digital data is available [now], the ecosystem provides many enablers like [credit] bureau data, GST data, our own account data, which we are able to combine and assess these customers in a better manner today.

Corporate credit has been stagnating for the last three to four years... But private investment obviously is happening only in certain sectors. The core sectors like steel and cement, despite having capacity utilisation of 70-75%, are not witnessing new investments